

21-User Small Business

On-Prem AD → Entra ID (Azure AD) Migration

How Technijian moved a 21-user small business off an aging on-premise Active Directory onto Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) — preserving OneDrive, Outlook, and user profiles while retiring the on-prem server.

PROFILE	ENVIRONMENT	SERVICES ENGAGED	ENGAGEMENT SCOPE
Small Business / SMB	21 desktop users, on-prem AD	Cloud migration, identity, M365	44–50 hrs (phased)

THE CHALLENGE

A 21-user small business relied on an **aging on-premise Active Directory server** for user logins, file access, and group policy. The server was past its useful life, the cost of a physical refresh was hard to justify for the user count, and remote work had made the on-prem domain model feel increasingly out of step with how the team actually worked.

The business wanted to move identity to **Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)**, decommission the on-prem server, and get out of the hardware-refresh cycle — *without* breaking OneDrive, Outlook, or the user profiles people had built up over years.

- ✓ **Aging on-prem AD** with 21 user accounts and local profiles
- ✓ **Hardware refresh looming** — hard to justify CapEx for 21 users
- ✓ **Remote work** made the on-prem model increasingly awkward
- ✓ **OneDrive & Outlook must survive** the identity cutover intact
- ✓ **User profiles** need to transfer, not be rebuilt
- ✓ **No time for an extended outage** — people have work to do

THE SOLUTION

Technijian planned and executed a **phased cloud identity migration**: full environment assessment, target-state design, controlled cutover of each desktop, validation of OneDrive and Outlook functionality post-cutover, and formal decommissioning of the legacy on-prem server with documentation.

PHASE 1 Evaluation

Assess current AD environment, identify needs and risks, produce an evaluation report that guides the migration strategy.

PHASE 2 Design

Design the target Entra ID (Azure AD) environment: user roles, access levels, and policies documented before any change.

PHASE 3 Implementation

Unjoin each desktop from the on-prem domain, join Entra ID, transfer user profiles, validate OneDrive and Outlook.

PHASE 4 Decommission

Verify all data preserved in cloud, back up and securely decommission the old on-prem AD server, document the new setup.

WHAT WE PRESERVED

- ✓ **User identities** — all 21 users transitioned cleanly to Entra ID
- ✓ **OneDrive** — file sync and share behavior validated post-migration
- ✓ **Outlook** — mail, calendar, contacts intact through identity change
- ✓ **User profiles** — desktop profile transfer, not forced rebuild
- ✓ **Access levels** — role/permission mapping preserved in the new design
- ✓ **Business continuity** — staggered cutovers, not a big-bang weekend

PLATFORMS & TOOLS

- Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)
- On-Prem Active Directory
- Microsoft 365
- OneDrive for Business
- Outlook / Exchange Online
- Intune (endpoint mgmt)
- Azure Portal
- Windows Desktop Fleet
- Secure Server Decommission
- Documentation deliverable

WHY SMBS CHOOSE THIS

- No more server refresh CapEx
- Built for remote work
- Modern MFA / conditional access
- Lower operating overhead

ENGAGEMENT SCALE

21

USERS MIGRATED

4

PHASE DELIVERY

44-50

HOURS (PHASED)

1

LEGACY SERVER RETIRED

Stop renewing server warranties. Move identity to the cloud.

949.379.8500

THE RESULTS

The business now runs identity entirely in **Microsoft Entra ID**. The old on-prem server has been securely decommissioned. OneDrive, Outlook, and user profiles survived the cutover. The next server refresh doesn't exist — because the server doesn't exist anymore. And the whole environment is documented for the next IT engagement, whether it's Technijian or not.

OUTCOME METRIC	RESULT
Identity platform	All 21 users migrated to Microsoft Entra ID with role and access-level mapping preserved from the on-prem design.
OneDrive & Outlook continuity	OneDrive sync and Outlook mailbox / calendar / contacts verified working for every user after identity cutover — no rebuild required.
Desktop transitions	Each desktop unjoined from the on-prem domain and joined to Entra ID with user profile transfer, not wipe-and-reload.
Legacy server retirement	Old on-prem AD server backed up, validated out of service, and securely decommissioned with proper documentation.
Documentation deliverable	Formal documentation of the new Entra ID setup handed over — including user roles, access policies, and decommission records.
Operating model change	No more on-prem AD to patch, reboot, or refresh. Remote-work posture significantly improved via cloud-native identity.
Delivery approach	Four-phase delivery (Evaluation → Design → Implementation → Decommission) with stakeholder signoff at each gate.

REPRESENTATIVE DELIVERABLES

Evaluation report — Assessment of current AD environment, users, risks, and constraints — the document that drove every downstream decision.

Cutover runbook — Per-desktop unjoin / Entra ID join / profile transfer procedure with rollback criteria and user-comms checklist.

Server decommission record — Final backup, data-retention confirmation, secure shutdown, and formal decommission documentation.

Entra ID design — Target-state design document: user roles, access levels, conditional-access and MFA policies, and group structure.

OneDrive / Outlook validation — Post-cutover verification for each user: mailbox working, OneDrive syncing, Teams signed in, shared access intact.

New-environment documentation — Operational handoff document describing the Entra ID setup, covering admin, user lifecycle, and support access.

REPRESENTATIVE OUTCOME

“A 21-user small business retired its aging on-premise Active Directory server and moved identity to Microsoft Entra ID with OneDrive, Outlook, and user profiles fully preserved — delivered in four phases with stakeholder signoff at each gate and formal documentation handoff at the end.”

— Anonymized engagement summary · based on two 44–50 hr cloud-migration proposals (cloud-migration-6838 / 6839)